

U N I T 4 · L E S S O N 5

Grace With Hard People

20–25 min · Week 26

OBJECTIVE Students articulate that grace toward hard people — the rude, prickly, or unkind — is a choice, with limits set by their own safety and dignity.

CASEL FOCUS Relationship Skills · grace with discernment; Self-Management: limits

VOCABULARY hard people · prickly · rude · limits · safety · dignity · cost

MATERIALS Sammy puppet · chart paper · scenario examples

ILLINOIS SEL ALIGNMENT GRADES K-2 · EARLY ELEMENTARY

Goal 2 — Social Awareness & Interpersonal Skills

2D.1a Identify problems and conflicts commonly experienced by peers.

2D.1b Identify approaches to resolving conflicts constructively.

Aligned to the Illinois Social/Emotional Learning Standards (ISBE).

O P E N I N G R E V I E W · 1 – 2 M I N

Show the small acts register. "Last lesson: small acts of grace. Today: what about with people who are HARD to be kind to?"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"There is someone in my life who is prickly. They are not mean exactly — but they are HARD to be kind to. What do I do?"

► **DIRECT INSTRUCTION**

Scripted teaching sequence · 4 STEPS · read aloud or in your own words

01 Hard People Are Real

5 MIN

Validate: "Some people are hard. They are rude sometimes. They are prickly. They make us tense. They are real — in classrooms, in families, in life. We do not have to PRETEND they are easy."

02 Choose Your Grace

6 MIN

Build the framework: "With hard people, you CHOOSE your grace. Maybe small — a polite hello. Maybe medium — a kind word when they seem stressed. Maybe big — inviting them to sit with you. YOU decide. The amount can be small. The CHOICE is yours."

03 But Limits Are Real Too

6 MIN

State firmly: "AND — grace has LIMITS. If a hard person is hurting you — grace is NOT required. Your SAFETY matters. Your DIGNITY matters. You can give a tiny grace and STILL keep your distance. You can give NO grace if it costs you safety."

04 Closing

4 MIN

Land the message: "Grace with hard people is a small CHOICE you make — with your safety and dignity intact. Sometimes the grace is just 'I will not be mean back.' That counts."

Sammy: *"I choose my grace. I keep my safety."*

KINDERGARTEN**GRADES 1 – 2**

Stay with: "Some people are hard. We can choose to be kind a TINY bit — OR — keep our distance. Both are okay."

Discuss specific scenarios: a peer who often makes fun, a sibling who is unkind, a family member who is grumpy. For each: what tiny grace might be possible? What limits matter?

EXIT TICKET

"My grace. My safety. Both matter." — say it together."

Sammy: thumbs-up to every hand. No commentary. Sammy validates participation, not content.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Which students argued grace MUST be given to anyone? Which argued NO grace is owed to hard people? Both are off-balance. The work is the discernment.

SAFETY CHECK

POST-LESSON CLOSE-OUT · A student who described a hard person who is in fact harming them — follow Disclosure Protocol. Grace is not a salve for ongoing harm.

Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up? ☐ No ☐ Yes — contact counselor today

FAMILY CONNECTION

A Note Home

Today we discussed grace with hard people — with limits. At home, when your child mentions a difficult person, ask: "What is one TINY kind thing you could choose? What is one limit you need to keep?" Both matter.

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE

This is a free preview.

Sample Lesson · Book 1 · The Foundation (K–2)

The complete, classroom-ready curriculum — with anchor charts, worksheets, Illinois SEL alignment, and scripted Direct Instruction — is part of the Architecture of Grace district library. Educators can license the full set; families can find materials in the family store.

architectureofgrace.org